BLK Stock Pitch Competition — 4-Day Sprint Plan

Nicholas Hawkins | Hawkins Holdings | April 3–6, 2026

STRATEGIC FRAME

Competition thesis: BlackRock (NYSE: BLK) is the highest-quality capital allocation in asset management for 2026 — a fee-compounding platform at the intersection of indexed investing, private markets, and financial operating-system infrastructure, currently trading ~21% below its 52-week high with 35%+ consensus upside and a Q1 earnings catalyst 11 days out.

Winning edge: This is not a stock pick competition. It is an AI-augmented investment process demonstration. The winner will be the team whose artifact proves that agentic AI — orchestrated across research, synthesis, modeling, visualization, and adversarial testing — can produce institutional-grade analysis that no individual analyst could replicate in the same timeframe. Your Perplexity + Claude + live data stack is that proof.

Portfolio value beyond the prize:

- **Public Finance (PA 271):** Institutional capital allocation frameworks, fiduciary duty analysis, governance structures of sovereign wealth funds and pension systems
- **GIS (GEOG 338):** Spatial visualization of BlackRock's global AUM distribution, market penetration mapping, geographic revenue concentration analysis
- **Thesis (Below the Line):** BlackRock as a governance system — $14T in AUM means their allocation decisions shape the capital geography of nations. The same analytical lens you apply to Dallas TIF districts applies to BLK's infrastructure investment decisions through GIP
- **Hawkins Holdings:** Flagship capability demonstration — institutional-grade research built with frontier AI tools

---

WHAT EXISTS (Inventory of Completed Work)

Asset	Status	Quality	Gaps
Perplexity Initial Inquiry Report	Complete	Strong thesis architecture, three-layer conviction stack	Data needs April refresh; bear case too soft

Asset	Status	Quality	Gaps
18-Slide HTML Flagship Deck	Complete	Polished visual design, gold/blue aesthetic, animated transitions	Static; no interactivity; no DCF model; no live data
5-Layer Implementation Plan	Complete	Institutional-grade blueprint (evidence → valuation → memo → artifact → adversarial)	Timeline was 4 weeks; must compress to 4 days
Competitor Analysis	Complete	Covers ETF, alternatives, technology segments	Needs current market cap / P/E refresh
Adversarial Objection Register	Complete	5 objections with research queries and rebuttal anchors	Needs 3 more objections (tariffs, key-man, credit contagion)

DAY 1 — THURSDAY, APRIL 3

Theme: Evidence Lock + Data Spine Hardening

Morning Block (3–4 hours)

Task 1.1: Live Data Refresh

- Platform: Claude (web search + synthesis)
- Pull current BLK price, market cap, 52-week range, average analyst PT, buy/sell/hold distribution
- Update all financial metrics to reflect FY2025 actuals and Q1 2026E consensus
- Capture pre-market movement (BLK pre-market $926.42 as of April 3 — significant drop)
- Document: Create a "Data Spine" reference table with every number, its source, and its date
- Output: `BLK_Data_Spine_April2026.md` — the single source of truth for every number in every artifact

Task 1.2: Macro Context Update

- Platform: Claude (web search) + Perplexity Deep Research
- What moved BLK from $1,109 in early February to $926 pre-market today?
- Tariff/trade war impact on financial sector sentiment
- Private credit market contagion fears (Reuters reported jitters spilling to Wall Street this week)

- Morgan Stanley PT cut ($1,550 → $1,368) rationale — what changed in their model?
- Evercore ISI PT cut ($1,275 → $1,235) — flow data concerns
- Output: 1-page macro context brief that frames the entry point narrative

Task 1.3: Earnings Catalyst Modeling

- Platform: Claude (analysis)
- Q1 2026 EPS consensus: $12.40–$12.45
- Market-implied earnings reaction: ±5.55% (~$53 per share)
- Model three scenarios: beat by 5%+ (likely given Q4 beat pattern), in-line, miss
- Map each scenario to a 30-day price path
- Frame for the competition: "We are presenting a pre-catalyst thesis with a verifiable event window"
- Output: Earnings catalyst scenario table (3 rows × 5 columns)

Afternoon Block (3–4 hours)

Task 1.4: Bear Case Hardening

- This is the single highest-leverage task for Day 1
- Expand the objection register from 5 to 8 objections:
  1. Market beta / paying 27x for AUM-linked revenue (existing)
  2. HPS/GIP integration execution risk (existing)
  3. Private credit overcrowding / systemic risk (existing — needs sharpening with IMF/BIS data)
  4. ETF fee compression structural headwind (existing)
  5. Larry Fink key-man risk / succession (existing)
  6. **NEW: Tariff/trade war macro drag on global capital flows**
  7. **NEW: Regulatory risk — FSOC scrutiny of systemically important financial institutions**
  8. **NEW: Technology moat erosion — Bloomberg/MSCI competitive response to Aladdin+Preqin**
- For each: research query → evidence → structured rebuttal with specific data points
- Platform: Claude (web search for current data) + Perplexity (Deep Research for historical/academic validation)
- Output: `BLK_Adversarial_Register.md` — the Q&A prep document

Task 1.5: Source Map

- Every claim in the thesis needs a primary source citation
- SEC filings (10-K, 10-Q, earnings press releases)
- BlackRock IR page: ir.blackrock.com
- Analyst reports (Morgan Stanley, Evercore, consensus via FactSet/Bloomberg proxies)
- Academic/industry sources (McKinsey convergence thesis, IMF private credit reports)
- Output: Numbered source index that maps to every claim in the artifact

Day 1 Deliverables:

- [ ] `BLK_Data_Spine_April2026.md`
- [ ] Macro context brief (1 page)
- [ ] Earnings catalyst scenario table
- [ ] `BLK_Adversarial_Register.md` (8 objections, fully sourced)
- [ ] Source index (40+ primary sources mapped)

DAY 2 — FRIDAY, APRIL 4

Theme: Artifact Architecture + Interactive Build

This is the make-or-break day. The artifact is the competition.

Morning Block (4–5 hours)

Task 2.1: Artifact Architecture Decision

- The existing Perplexity HTML deck is a strong starting point but is static
- The competition-winning artifact must demonstrate AI capability through interactivity
- Architecture: React single-page application (JSX artifact) with the following modules:

Module A: Thesis Overview

- Hero section with live price data reference, consensus upside, AUM
- The "three-layer conviction stack" as an interactive component (click each layer to expand evidence)
- Narrative framing: "BlackRock is becoming the core infrastructure layer of modern asset allocation"

Module B: Strategic Evolution Timeline

- Interactive timeline of GIP (Oct 2024) → Preqin (Mar 2025) → HPS (Jul 2025)
- Each node expands to show AUM impact, strategic rationale, integration status
- Animated AUM waterfall: show organic flows ($698B) vs. inorganic additions

Module C: Financial Quality Dashboard

- Key metrics: Revenue ($24.2B), Adj. EPS ($48.09), AUM ($14T), Adj. Operating Margin (44.1%)
- FY2022–FY2025 trend visualization (bar charts or sparklines)
- Revenue mix breakdown showing the shift from public-market-centric to multi-surface

Module D: DCF Sensitivity Calculator ← THE DIFFERENTIATOR

- Interactive inputs: WACC (slider: 8%–12%), terminal growth rate (slider: 2%–4%), alternatives revenue mix (slider: current → bull case)
- Real-time output: intrinsic value per share, implied upside/downside
- Three pre-set scenarios (bear/base/bull) with one-click loading
- This proves the thesis is stress-tested, not just asserted

Module E: Peer Comparison Matrix

- BLK vs. BX, KKR, APO, ARES, T. Rowe Price
- Interactive toggle between P/E, EV/EBITDA, revenue growth, operating margin
- Visual emphasis on BLK's unique positioning across all four surfaces

Module F: Risk Register

- Expandable accordion for each of the 8 objections
- Each expands to: objection statement → evidence → structured mitigant → source citations
- Color-coded severity: red (material), amber (monitored), green (mitigated)

Module G: Catalyst Calendar

- Timeline showing upcoming catalysts: Q1 earnings (Apr 14), HPS synergy data, Aladdin ACV updates
- Pre-catalyst positioning rationale

Module H: AI Process Documentation ← COMPETITION META-LAYER

- A "How This Was Built" section showing the agentic AI workflow

- Perplexity Deep Research → Claude synthesis → live data validation → interactive artifact
- This is the flex: showing the judges the process, not just the output

Task 2.2: Build the Core React Artifact

- Platform: Claude (code generation → JSX artifact)
- Design language: Carry forward the gold/blue institutional aesthetic from the Perplexity deck
- Typography: Distinctive display font + clean body font (not Inter)
- Responsive layout with smooth transitions
- All data sourced from the Day 1 data spine
- Target: Functional prototype with Modules A–E by end of morning block

Afternoon Block (4–5 hours)

Task 2.3: Complete Modules F–H

- Build the risk register accordion
- Build the catalyst calendar
- Build the AI process documentation section
- Polish transitions, loading states, mobile responsiveness

Task 2.4: DCF Model Calibration

- Inputs: FY2025 revenue $24.22B, consensus FY2026E ~$28B, adjusted EPS $48.09
- WACC calculation: Risk-free rate (~4.3%), equity risk premium (~5.5%), beta (1.20)
- Terminal value: perpetuity growth method, 2.5% base case
- Free cash flow estimation from adjusted operating income, capex, working capital
- Validate model outputs against analyst consensus PT range ($1,150–$1,467)
- Embed model logic into the interactive calculator

Task 2.5: Peer Data Refresh

- Pull current market caps, P/E ratios, and revenue growth for all five comparables
- Ensure the peer table in the artifact uses April 2026 data, not stale numbers

Day 2 Deliverables:

- [ ] Functional React artifact with all 8 modules
- [ ] Interactive DCF calculator with bull/base/bear scenarios

- [ ] Peer comparison dashboard with current data
- [ ] Risk register with 8 expandable objections
- [ ] AI process documentation section

DAY 3 — SATURDAY, APRIL 5

Theme: IC Memo + Narrative Polish + Adversarial Stress Test

Morning Block (4–5 hours)

Task 3.1: Investment Committee Memo Draft

- Platform: Claude (long-form writing)
- Structure (6–8 pages, institutional grade):
  - Section 1: Executive Summary (1 page) — Recommendation, thesis, risk summary, expected return
  - Section 2: Investment Thesis (1.5 pages) — Secular growth market, mispricing argument, catalyst set
  - Section 3: Financial Analysis (2 pages) — Income statement trends, AUM waterfall, GAAP vs. adjusted earnings bridge, DCF summary
  - Section 4: Industry & Competitive Landscape (1 page) — McKinsey convergence thesis, four-surface positioning, peer table
  - Section 5: Risk Register (1 page) — 8 risks with specific evidence-based mitigants
  - Section 6: Portfolio Fit & Position Sizing (0.5 page) — Flagship vs. satellite, correlation, liquidity
  - Section 7: Conclusion & Monitoring Triggers (0.5 page) — What would change the thesis
- Voice: Academic register per Nick's scholarly standards — thesis-forward, every claim defensible under peer scrutiny, no hedged conclusions where evidence is clear
- Every number traces back to the Day 1 data spine
- Output: `BLK_IC_Memo_April2026.pdf` (formatted, print-ready)

Task 3.2: 2-Page Executive Brief

- Platform: Claude (condensed writing)
- PDF-format written brief suitable for forwarding
- No graphics — structured paragraphs with cited data

- Designed to be marked up, compared against diligence findings
- Output: `BLK_Executive_Brief.pdf`

Afternoon Block (4–5 hours)

Task 3.3: Adversarial Red Team Session

- Platform: Claude (structured challenge protocol)
- For each section of the IC memo, run the "devil's advocate" pass:
  - What is the strongest version of the counter-argument?
  - What data would falsify this claim?
  - What is the judge most likely to challenge?
- Document every weakness found and either:
  - Fix it (revise the memo/artifact)
  - Acknowledge it (add to risk register with honest assessment)
- Special focus areas:
  - Is the 38% upside claim still valid at today's price vs. today's consensus? (Morgan Stanley cut PT)
  - Is the private credit thesis overcrowded? (Multiple competitors making the same pitch)
  - Does the tariff environment change the AUM growth trajectory?

Task 3.4: Narrative Coherence Check

- Read the artifact, IC memo, and executive brief in sequence
- Ensure they tell the same story at different altitudes
- The artifact is the pitch; the memo is the proof; the brief is the forward-to-your-colleague version
- No contradictions, no orphaned claims, no unsupported numbers

Task 3.5: Cross-Pollination Documentation

- Write a 1-page "Portfolio Integration Brief" that maps this project to:
  - PA 271 (Intro to Public Administration): Institutional governance, fiduciary frameworks, sovereign wealth fund decision-making processes as public administration case study
  - GEOG 338 (GIS): Spatial analysis of BlackRock's global footprint — where is the $14T concentrated? Where are the growth vectors? This is economic geography

    - Thesis (Below the Line): BlackRock's infrastructure investments through GIP literally shape the built environment. The same governance lens — who benefits, who bears risk, who decides — applies at the planetary scale
    - Hawkins Holdings: This artifact is a consulting capability proof-of-concept
- Output: `BLK_Portfolio_Integration.md`

Day 3 Deliverables:

- [ ] `BLK_IC_Memo_April2026.pdf` (6–8 pages, institutional grade)
- [ ] `BLK_Executive_Brief.pdf` (2 pages, forwardable)
- [ ] Adversarial red team log with resolutions
- [ ] Artifact revised based on stress test findings
- [ ] `BLK_Portfolio_Integration.md`

DAY 4 — SUNDAY, APRIL 6

Theme: Final Assembly + Competition Submission

Morning Block (3–4 hours)

Task 4.1: Final Data Refresh

- Pull Friday close price for BLK (market closed over weekend, but check for any after-hours/pre-market Monday indicators)
- Confirm all artifact numbers match the latest available data
- Check for any material news (SEC filings, analyst upgrades/downgrades, management commentary)
- Update the data spine if anything changed

Task 4.2: Artifact Final Polish

- Design refinement: spacing, typography, color consistency, animation timing
- Mobile responsiveness check
- Performance optimization (load time matters for judges)
- Add metadata: title, author, date, competition attribution
- Final copy edit: every word earns its place

Task 4.3: Submission Package Assembly

- Component 1: Interactive React artifact (the primary deliverable)
- Component 2: IC Memo PDF (supporting analytical depth)
- Component 3: Executive Brief PDF (the "forward to your colleague" version)
- Component 4: AI Process Documentation (embedded in artifact + standalone if needed)
- Confirm submission format requirements and adjust packaging accordingly

Afternoon Block (2–3 hours)

Task 4.4: Voice Pass

- Read every word of every deliverable through the lens: "Does this sound like Nick Hawkins?"
- Strategic, culturally literate, authority-forward, clean structure, strong thesis
- No throat-clearing, no hedges where evidence is clear, no filler
- The reader is intelligent — challenge them

Task 4.5: Submission

- Final review against competition requirements
- Submit before deadline
- Document the submission for Hawkins Holdings portfolio

TOOL ALLOCATION BY PLATFORM

Platform	Role	Days
Claude (this session)	Synthesis, artifact build, IC memo drafting, adversarial testing, narrative polish	All 4
Perplexity Deep Research	Primary source validation, SEC filing extraction, earnings transcript queries	Day 1, Day 3
Perplexity Finance Tools	Real-time quote data, consensus estimates, peer comps	Day 1, Day 2
Web Search (Claude)	Current news, analyst commentary, macro context, breaking developments	All 4

Platform	Role	Days
Claude Code / Artifacts	React interactive application build, DCF calculator, data visualization	Day 2 (primary), Day 3–4 (refinement)

RISK REGISTER FOR THE SPRINT ITSELF

Risk	Mitigation
Data goes stale before submission	Schedule final refresh on Day 4 morning; use "as of [date]" timestamps on all figures
Artifact scope creep delays completion	Modules A–E are must-haves; F–H are should-haves; cut H before cutting D
Bear case isn't sharp enough to impress judges	Dedicate full Day 1 afternoon to adversarial hardening; the bear case should be better than any judge would make it
BLK drops significantly before submission (pre-market already at $926)	This is a FEATURE, not a bug — a lower entry point strengthens the upside thesis if fundamentals haven't changed. Frame it explicitly.
Q1 earnings (Apr 14) could invalidate the thesis	Acknowledge the event window in the pitch. Position as pre-catalyst conviction call. Model all three scenarios.
Competition requires specific format we haven't confirmed	CHECK SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS BEFORE STARTING DAY 2 BUILD. Adjust artifact format accordingly.

SUCCESS METRICS

The pitch wins if it demonstrates:

1. **Analytical depth** that exceeds what a traditional analyst could produce in the same timeframe
2. **AI-augmented process** that is visible, documented, and reproducible
3. **Interactivity** that lets judges interrogate the thesis themselves (the DCF calculator is the key)
4. **Adversarial honesty** — the bear case is presented with the same rigor as the bull case

5. **Narrative coherence** — thesis → evidence → model → risk → conviction flows without gaps
6. **Institutional quality** — a sovereign wealth fund IC member would take this seriously
7. **Distinctive voice** — this reads like a scholar-practitioner who understands both the theory and the trade

---

IMMEDIATE NEXT ACTION

After reviewing this plan, the highest-leverage move is to confirm the competition's submission requirements (format, length, evaluation criteria) and then begin Task 1.1: Live Data Refresh. Everything else builds on the data spine.

Sprint plan generated April 3, 2026. All times approximate — adjust based on energy and flow. The plan is a map, not a cage.